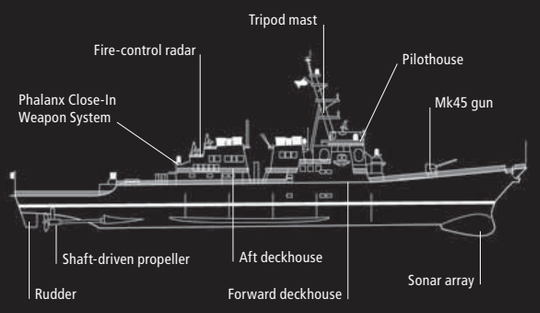
USS DONALD COOK

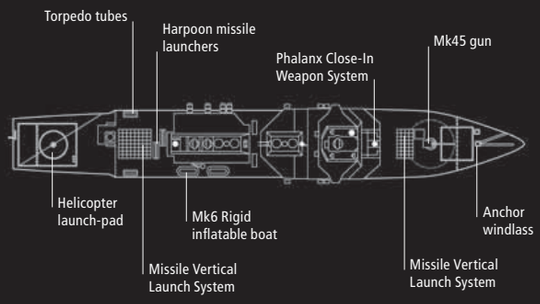
THE ARLEIGH BURKE-CLASS guided-missile destroyer *Donald Cook*, named for a Marine hero of the Vietnam War, was launched in 1997. Deployed in Operation Iraqi Freedom in March 2003 as part of the Battle Group led by the carrier *Harry S Truman*, she was among the first ships to launch Tomahawk cruise missiles against targets in Iraq.

THE FIRST ARLEIGH BURKE-CLASS destroyer was commissioned in 1991. *Donald Cook* belongs to Flight II, incorporating significant advances in armament and electronics. The ship is packed with diverse weaponry, giving her what the US Navy calls "multi-mission offensive and defensive capabilities." The Mk41 vertical launch system fires anti-aircraft missiles, anti-submarine missiles, missiles for destroying other surface ships, and cruise missiles for strike operations against land targets. The destroyer does not have the covered helicopter hangar fitted to later ships in the class, but a launch-pad allows an attack helicopter to be embarked. Survivability is a key concept in the destroyer's design and equipment. The Arleigh Burke-class were among the first ships to incorporate elements of "stealth" technology, with buried funnels and rounded shapes to reduce the ship's radar profile, as well as features to suppress infrared emissions. They were also the first American all-steel warships. Replacing the aluminum superstructure with steel was meant to reduce damage in case of a missile hit. The destroyer has a crew of 30 officers and more than 300 enlisted personnel.



Stealth warship
The USS *Donald Cook* and her fellow Arleigh Burke-class destroyers are among the most advanced surface combatants in service today.





USS Donald Cook
Donald Cook is the 25th Arleigh Burke-class guided-missile destroyer to be built for the US Navy. Despite being classed as a destroyer, *Donald Cook* is over 150m (500ft) in length and displaces 8,400 tons when full, making her similar in size to many World War II cruisers.

> "THESE DESTROYERS ... ARE A SPECIAL CLASS OF SHIPS, THE CLASS OF ARLEIGH BURKE. ADMIRAL BURKE WAS THE INSPIRATION FOR THESE SHIPS. THEY WERE MEANT TO BE FEARED AND FAST, THE VERY ATTRIBUTES THAT EARNED THEIR NAMESAKE THE NICKNAME "31-KNOT BURKE."
>
> **PRESIDENT BILL CLINTON**, SPEECH AT THE FUNERAL SERVICE OF ADMIRAL ARLEIGH BURKE, 1996



» Landing indicator lights
A system of lights helps to guide the helicopter in to land. A green light indicates a good approach, amber caution, and red that the helicopter is too low. Two flashing red lights tell the pilot to abort.

» Helicopter landing-pad
Donald Cook can embark and refuel an SH-60 Seahawk helicopter, providing search and attack capabilities as well as an effective way to move cargo and personnel.





» Torpedo tubes
Two sets of Mk32 triple torpedo tubes can be used to target submarines. The system fires the torpedoes using compressed air from a flask at the rear of tubes.